

1 Introduction

1.1 Qualification aims

These qualifications will assess the application of ICT skills through their practical use. They will provide learners with essential knowledge, transferable skills and tools to improve their learning in other subjects with the aims of enhancing their employability when they leave education, contributing to their personal development and future economic well-being.

The Cambridge Nationals in ICT will equip learners with sound ICT skills for everyday use and provide opportunities to develop in context those desirable, transferable skills such as planning, research and analysis, working with others or communicating technical concepts effectively. They will also challenge all learners, including high attaining learners, by introducing them to demanding material and skills; encouraging independence and creativity; providing tasks that engage them.

The hands-on approach that will be required for both teaching and learning will chime appropriately with the way young people use new technology and will underpin a highly valid approach to the assessment of their skills. The qualification design, including the range of units available, will allow learners the freedom to explore more deeply the things that interest them as well as providing good opportunity to enhance their learning in a range of curriculum areas.

This specification contains OCR's Cambridge National Award/Certificate in ICT.

1.2 Qualification summary

The Cambridge Nationals in ICT consist of two qualifications:

The OCR Level 1/2 Cambridge National Award in ICT consists of two mandatory units.

The OCR Level 1/2 Cambridge National Certificate in ICT consists of two mandatory units and two optional units.

1.3 Qualification size (GLH and TQT)

The size of the qualification is described in terms of Guided Learning Hours (GLH) and Total Qualification Time (TQT).

GLH indicates the approximate time (in hours) the teacher will spend supervising or directing study time and assessment activities. We have worked with people who are experienced in delivering related qualifications to determine what content needs to be taught and how long it will take to deliver.

TQT is comprised of two elements: GLH, and an estimate of the number of hours a learner will reasonably spend on any unsupervised learning or assessment activities (including homework) so they can successfully achieve their qualification.

OCR Level 1/2 Cambridge National Award in ICT is 60 GLH and 71 TQT.

OCR Level 1/2 Cambridge National Certificate in ICT is 120 GLH and 151 TQT.

1.4 Prior learning/attainment

Learners who are taking courses leading to any of these qualifications should normally correspond to Key Stage 3 Programme of Study within the National Curriculum.

1.5 Overview of the qualifications

Units	Assessment method	GLH	J800 Award 60 GLH
Mandatory			
R001: <i>Understanding computer systems</i>	Written paper OCR set and marked 1 hour – 60 marks (60 UMS) Learners answer all questions	30	M [±]
R002: <i>Using ICT to create solutions in a business environment</i>	Centre-assessed tasks OCR-moderated Approx 10 hours – 60 marks (60 UMS)	30	M*
Business information systems strand			
R003: <i>Handling data using spreadsheets</i>	Centre-assessed tasks OCR-moderated Approx 10 hours – 60 marks (60 UMS)	30	N/A
R004: <i>Handling data using databases</i>	Centre-assessed tasks OCR-moderated Approx 10 hours – 60 marks (60 UMS)	30	N/A
Creative Strand			
R005: <i>Creating an interactive product using multimedia components</i>	Centre-assessed tasks OCR-moderated Approx 10 hours – 60 marks (60 UMS)	30	N/A
R006: <i>Creating digital images</i>	Centre-assessed tasks OCR-moderated Approx 10 hours – 60 marks (60 UMS)	30	N/A
R007: <i>Creating dynamic products using sound and vision</i>	Centre-assessed tasks OCR-moderated Approx 10 hours – 60 marks (60 UMS)	30	N/A
Key: M = mandatory unit O = optional unit			

A bank of OCR-set assignments is available free of charge from the OCR website for centre-assessed units R002 – R007

*June 2021 series is the final moderation opportunity for OCR Cambridge National A Certificate in ICT Units R002 – R007.

±January 2022 is the final resit opportunity for Unit R001.